

Day 8 — Project Session 1: Outline Your Paper

Module: Pañcabhūta (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students choose a focused paper topic, draft a one-paragraph thesis, and produce a working outline.

Materials

- Project brief ([assessments/project-brief.md](#))
- Rubric ([assessments/rubric.md](#))
- Laptop or notebook for drafting

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Hand out the rubric. Read aloud the *thesis* and *counter-argument* criteria.

Core: outlining (30 min)

Sprint 1 (10 min) — Topic. Each student writes: - Working title (1 line) - One-paragraph thesis (3–4 sentences) - 3 sources they'll cite (must include one primary scriptural, one secondary scholarly, one comparative or modern)

Teacher rotates: 60 sec per student, single question: “*What’s the counter-argument someone could make against your thesis?*”

Sprint 2 (10 min) — Outline. Each student writes section headings + 1-line sub-points: - Introduction (with thesis statement) - Section 1 (anchor claim + source) - Section 2 (anchor claim + source) - Counter-argument and response - Conclusion

Sprint 3 (10 min) — Begin drafting. Each student starts the introduction or one body paragraph.

Wrap-up (10 min)

- Each student exchanges outline with one buddy.
- 3-min mutual feedback: 1 strength + 1 fix.
- Outline + thesis submitted at the door.

Homework

- Draft 1–2 more paragraphs at home. Bring everything tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add a 4th source — a contemporary academic article (search Google Scholar).

- **Tier down:** Topic can be narrow (“a comparison of one Sāṅkhya tanmātra concept with the modern five-senses model”). Narrower is fine.

Teacher notes

- Common pitfall: too-broad topic. Push for specificity early.
- A weak thesis sounds like “Indian science is interesting.” A strong thesis sounds like “The Sāṅkhya tanmātra–indriya symmetry offers a model that 19th-century European psychophysics independently rediscovered.”